



Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 · Set up your agent in the new builder

1 Create your agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create**, then **New agent**. In the redesigned builder everything lives under the **Build** tab, with a settings panel down the right. Set:

Agent name Frontline Shift Handover Copilot

Description Helps shift leads write handover notes, log safety incidents, run pre-shift checks, and spot recurring near-misses across sites.

Solution / Environment Frontline Solution · Default environment

Icon Use a recognisable colour and emoji, or upload a brand icon

2 Choose your model

Open the **Model** selector at the top of the right-hand panel. Copilot Studio now lets you pick the model your agent reasons with. This build uses **Claude Sonnet 4.6**; you can switch later without rebuilding.

Reasoning is built in

- The agent reasons over your instructions, knowledge, skills and tools, and decides what to do each turn
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks and follow-ups
- Blends a knowledge lookup with a tool call in one reply
- Calls the right skill when intent matches

Choosing a model

- Claude Sonnet 4.6: strong reasoning, a good default here
- Lighter models: lower latency and cost for simple, high-volume flows
- Switch the model and re-run the same evaluation set to compare
- Check data residency and model availability for your tenant

3 Write your instructions

The **Instructions** box is the heart of the Build tab. Define the agent's role, audiences and rules here. The agent reasons over these together with everything in the right-hand panel. Paste:

You are the Frontline Shift Handover Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Shift leads writing the end-of-shift handover and logging incidents.
- 2) Site and safety managers spotting recurring near-misses across sites.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded shift dataset as your single source of truth.
- Keep replies short; shift leads are on a hand-held device, often standing up.
- For a handover, stitch in equipment checks and any open actions automatically.
- For a near-miss or incident, call the 'Log Safety Incident' tool. Never just say it is logged.
- Surface any incident type recurring across sites in the chosen window.
- Treat safety data with care: leads see their site, managers see their patch.



Build Steps

Part 2 of 5 · Ground it in your data

4 Add Knowledge

Open **Knowledge** in the panel, select **Add knowledge**, then **File**, and upload **Frontline_Shifts_Data.xlsx**. Knowledge gives the agent trusted context to guide its answers. This file contains:

- Shift details (shift ID, site, date, shift lead, shift pattern)
- Handover data (open actions, equipment checks, notes)
- Safety data (incident type, severity, near-miss flag, status)
- Trend data (site, incident category, date for roll-ups)

Layer more sources later: SharePoint sites, Dataverse, Microsoft Graph connectors, or public web.

5 Bring in Microsoft IQ

Open **Microsoft IQ** in the panel. Microsoft IQ brings in work context, business data and app signals from across your tenant, so the agent grounds answers in more than the file you uploaded.

For this agent, Microsoft IQ brings in the site roster and the previous shift's open actions, so a handover starts from what actually happened rather than a blank note. Microsoft IQ honours each user's existing permissions, so the agent only surfaces what the signed-in user is already allowed to see.

Build Steps

Part 3 of 5 · Give it skills and tools

6 Add a Skill

Open **Skills** in the panel, then **Add a skill**. A skill defines a reusable behaviour through structured instructions. It is the new home for the conversational flows you used to build as topics: the agent calls the skill when a user's intent matches.

Skill name: Write Shift Handover Note

Description: Captures a structured end-of-shift handover from the shift lead, stitches in equipment checks and any incidents, and stores the note against the shift row.

When to use it (intent hints the agent reasons over):

- Write my handover note
- End of shift handover
- Hand over to the next shift
- Close out my shift

Structured steps:

- Identify the shift (default to the signed-in lead's current shift) and site
- Pull open actions and equipment checks for the shift from knowledge
- Ask for any incidents or near-misses during the shift
- Compose the handover: status, open actions, equipment, incidents
- Store the note against the shift row and offer to log any incident via the tool
- Confirm the handover reference returned



7 Add a Tool

Open **Tools**, then **Add a tool**. **Skills decide what to do; tools take the action**. A tool is a typed, callable action with named inputs and outputs that the model fills from the conversation. Choose one of: a **prebuilt connector** (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow and more), a **Power Automate cloud flow**, a **custom HTTP request**, or a **Model Context Protocol (MCP) server**. This build uses a Power Automate flow because it does three things in one call: log the incident, notify the safety officer, and return a reference.

Tool name: Log Safety Incident

Type: Power Automate flow to a Dataverse table 'SafetyIncidents', plus a Teams adaptive card

Description (the model reads this to decide when to call): Logs a near-miss or incident against the shift, notifies the site safety officer, and creates an open action for follow-up.

Inputs the agent collects or infers:

- shiftId — text, from context
- site — text, e.g. Packing Line North
- incidentType — text, e.g. Slip / Trip / Cut
- severity — text, one of Near-miss / Minor / Reportable
- description — text, the event in the lead's own words

Outputs returned to the agent:

- incidentReference — text, e.g. SI-20260608-3140
- status — text, e.g. Logged
- actionCreated — yes/no

7.1 · Build the cloud flow that does the work

From inside Copilot Studio choose **Tools > Add a tool > New > Power Automate**. This opens the flow designer pre-wired with the Copilot Studio trigger and, crucially, keeps the flow in the **same environment** as your agent (Frontline Solution · Default). An environment mismatch is the most common reason a finished tool never appears in the picker, so confirm the environment switcher (top-right) before you build.

Trigger — *When an agent calls the flow*. Add five text input parameters, named exactly: shiftId, site, incidentType, severity, description.

– **Action 1 – generate the reference.** Add *Initialize variable* incidentRef = concat('SI-', formatDateTime(utcNow(), 'yyyyMMdd'), '-', rand(1000, 9999)). (Or let Dataverse return the ID instead.)

– **Action 2 – log the incident.** Dataverse *Add a new row* (or SharePoint *Create item*) into the **SafetyIncidents** table. Map: Reference = incidentRef, Shift = shiftId, Site = site, Type = incidentType, Severity = severity, Description = description, Status = 'Logged'.

– **Action 3 – notify the safety officer.** Microsoft Teams *Post card in a chat or channel* to the site safety officer, using an adaptive card that shows the reference, site, type, severity and description.

– **Final action – return to the agent.** Add *Respond to the agent* (Return value(s) to Copilot Studio) with outputs incidentReference = variables('incidentRef'), status = 'Logged', actionCreated = true.

– **Save** the flow as Frontline – Log Safety Incident.



7.2 · Register and map the tool in your agent

- Back in Copilot Studio the flow is attached automatically; if you built it separately, **Tools > Add a tool > Flows** and select it.
- Set the display name to **Log Safety Incident** and write the **Description** for the model — it is what the agent reads to decide when to call the tool.
- For each input set **Fill using**: shiftId → *dynamically* from the signed-in lead's current shift; site, incidentType, severity and description → **Fill with AI**, and add an input description so the model extracts the right value (for severity, list Near-miss/Minor/Reportable and what each means).
- Confirm incidentReference is returned to the agent so the skill can read it back — satisfying your instruction rule “never just say it is logged”.
- **Connection & auth**: set the Dataverse and Teams connections the flow uses. The connectors chosen here are exactly what your DLP policy must permit (see Step 10).

7.3 · Worked example — what flows in and out

When a lead says “log a near-miss, minor finger injury in the packing line”, the model fills the inputs and calls the tool with this payload:

```
{
  "shiftId":      "SH-4471",
  "site":         "Packing Line North",
  "incidentType": "Cut - finger",
  "severity":     "Near-miss",
  "description":  "Finger caught on strapping edge; no first aid needed"
}
```

The flow logs the row, posts the card, and returns:

```
{
  "incidentReference": "SI-20260608-3140",
  "status":           "Logged",
  "actionCreated":    true
}
```

The agent then replies in natural language, quoting the real reference: “I’ve logged near-miss SI-20260608-3140 for Packing Line North and notified the site safety officer, with an open action raised for follow-up.”

7.4 · Test the tool before you trust it

- **In isolation**: open the flow in Power Automate, choose *Test > Manually*, supply the five inputs, run it, and confirm a row appears in the SafetyIncidents table, a card posts to the safety officer, and the run returns all three outputs.
- **End to end**: in **Preview** (Step 11) type “log a near-miss, minor finger injury in the packing line” and check the activity view shows Log Safety Incident firing with the inputs the model inferred and the reference it read back.



Build Steps

Part 4 of 5 · Extend, remember and govern

8 Add Connected agents

Open **Connected agents**. A connected agent lets this agent collaborate with others, delegating specialist work and sharing context across them (agent-to-agent). Keep each agent focused on what it does best.

Connect a **Maintenance Agent** so an equipment fault recorded in a handover can be raised as a work order in the same flow, rather than waiting for someone to re-key it.

9 Turn on Memory

Toggle **Memory** on. Memory lets the agent remember interactions, workflows and context across sessions, so returning users do not have to repeat themselves. For this agent it remembers:

- The lead's site and shift pattern, so the handover opens in the right context
- Recurring near-misses for the site, so the agent can prompt a permanent fix

Memory is scoped to each user and follows your retention and DLP policy. Review what the agent retains before you publish.

10 Govern your agent

Open the agent settings and lock these down before real users arrive:

Authentication: use *Authenticate with Microsoft (Entra)* so the agent runs as the signed-in user and inherits their permissions.

Content moderation: set the moderation level (start at Medium) and review it for your audience.

Data loss prevention: confirm your DLP policy covers the connectors your tools use — for Log Safety Incident that means the Dataverse and Teams connectors must sit in the same DLP group, or the tool is blocked at runtime.

Channels and access: review which channels are enabled and who can use the agent.

Build Steps

Part 5 of 5 · Preview, evaluate and publish

11 Preview your agent

Switch to the **Preview** tab to chat with your agent as you build. Open the **activity view** on any response to inspect:

- Which skill, tool or knowledge source fired, and in what order
- The inputs the agent collected and what each tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your data
- Latency per step, useful when tuning multi-tool flows



12 Evaluate

Open the **Evaluate** tab, then **New evaluation**. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change. Score each response on **groundedness** (did it stay inside the knowledge), **relevance** (did it address the question), and **accuracy** (did it match the expected outcome).

Test set: Frontline Shift Handover Copilot · Baseline v1

Input: Show open actions left by the previous shift lead

Expect: Returns open actions for the site's last shift, cites the shift ID.

Input: Which site has the most near-misses in the last 14 days?

Expect: Counts near-miss rows by site over 14 days and ranks them.

Input: Log a near-miss, minor finger injury in the packing line

Expect: Triggers the handover skill where relevant and calls Log Safety Incident.

13 Publish and Monitor

Click **Publish**, then enable the channels your users live in: Microsoft Teams, Microsoft 365 Copilot, a custom website embed, or other channels. Teams and M365 Copilot need tenant admin approval, so plan for that lead time. After publishing, open the **Monitor** tab to watch sessions, resolution and escalation outcomes, and quality trends over time, and to see where users drop off.

Try These Live

Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

End of Shift

Write my handover note for tonight's shift. · Show open actions left by the previous shift lead.

Safety Trends

Which site has the most near-misses in the last 14 days? · Are any incident types recurring across sites this week?

Governed Action

Log a near-miss, minor finger injury in the packing line.

Try a paraphrase: 'someone tripped on a pallet, no injury'.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces	With
• Paper handover sheets • Chat threads for near-miss reports • Hand-built weekly safety roll-ups	✓ Structured handovers in under a minute ✓ Every incident captured with a reference number ✓ Site-level safety trends visible in real time

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI.

Built once, used everywhere.



Tip for real-world use

Publish to Teams mobile first; shift leads should never have to leave their hand-held device to log an incident. Add a Power Automate approval branch so reportable incidents trigger an immediate notification to the duty safety manager, not just a Teams card.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Capture handovers in 60 seconds
- Log incidents from any device
- Surface recurring safety risks
- Keep every shift accountable